Owner's Manual

FLATLAND

Resistance Overview

Human nature is naturally resistant. Try taking a toy from a child and resistance immediately rears its head. This six-week series through the book of James shows how we are prone to resist God and miss out on what He desires to do. James then calls us to resist the devil instead so we can experience the righteousness of God.

- To help people identify where they are resisting God and invite Him to change their divided, proud and wandering hearts.
- To form resilient believers who resist the devil without caving into his lies.
- To move people from passive belief to active, obedient faith shaped by humility and trust.

Solitude

In Matthew 6:6 (The Message), Jesus said, “Here’s what I want you to do: Find a quite, secluded place so you won’t be tempted to role-play before God. Just be there as simply and honestly as you can manage. The focus will shift from you to God, and you will begin to sense his grace.”
Throughout this series, we invite you to practice the spiritual discipline of solitude. This Owner’s Manual provides simple tools for you to use during your quiet, secluded moments with God.

- **Bible Study** questions following each sermon to prepare for Life Group discussions
- **Examen** on page 16, an ancient spiritual practice that allows you to reflect with the Holy Spirit on your day
- Our **Resistance Scale** on page 17 to complete after each week’s sermon

WEEK 1

Resisting Trust

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: What you believe about God determines if you resist or trust Him in your trials.

Point 1: God _____ us through _____.

Point 2: God _____ us through _____.

Point 3: God _____ us through _____.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. What _____ are you _____ _____?

2. How could you _____ more of _____ _____?

3. What will help you _____ and _____ God more?

_____

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 1

Resisting Trust

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 1:9-12 and Matthew 13:3-9.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verses 9 and 10? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Matthew. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

WEEK 2

Resisting Obedience

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: Your view of humanity determines if you resist or obey God's commands.

Point 1: God _____ the _____.

Point 2: God _____ the _____.

Point 3: God _____ the _____.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. Who are the _____ you tend to _____?

2. What keeps you from _____ that _____?

3. What will _____ to _____ look like for you?

_____

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 2

Resisting Obedience

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 2:1-9 and Matthew 5:3-12, 43-48.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verse 5? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Matthew. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

WEEK 3

Resisting Wisdom

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: Your aspirations determine if you resist or follow God's wisdom.

Point 1: Let's aspire to _____ ___ the _____.

Point 2: Let's aspire to _____ a _____ _____.

Point 3: Let's aspire to ___ _____.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. How has your _____ been _____?

2. How will you regularly let _____ _____ your _____?

3. How will you make it your _____ to be a _____?

_____

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 3

Resisting Wisdom

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 3:13-18 and Matthew 6:1-4.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verse 14? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Matthew. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

WEEK 4

Resisting Authority

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: What you want determines if you resist or submit to God's authority.

Point 1: When _____ rules, _____ results.

Point 2: When _____ _____ rules, _____ results.

Point 3: When _____ rules, _____ results.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. In what ways are you _____ _____ to ____ _____ for _____ or _____?

2. To what degree have you _____ the _____ and _____ found in _____ _____?

3. What steps will you take to _____ _____ to God and _____ to _____ _____?

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 4

Resisting Authority

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 4:4-10 and Exodus 20:1-7.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verse 5? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Exodus. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

WEEK 5

Resisting Control

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: Your view of the good life determines if you resist or give God control.

Point 1: Surrender your _____.

Point 2: Surrender your _____.

Point 3: Surrender your _____.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. How has the _____ shaped your _____ of _____ _____ _____?

2. What _____ are keeping you from _____ God _____?

3. How does God want to _____ the _____ _____ for you?

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 5

Resisting Control

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 4:13-17 and Luke 12:13-21.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verse 17? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Luke. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

WEEK 6

Resisting Repentance

Sermon Notes

Big Idea: Your passion for repentance determines if you resist or move to the center.

Point 1: Repentance _____ sinners _____.

Point 2: Repentance _____ sinners _____ _____.

Point 3: Repentance _____ sinners _____ _____.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Reflection

1. What results when we _____ from _____ _____?

2. What happens when our _____ _____ _____ _____?

3. What could it look like for you to _____, and _____ _____ _____, to _____ _____?

_____

_____

_____

WEEK 6

Resisting Repentance

Bible Study for Group Discussion

Read James 5:19-20 and Galatians 6:1-2.

- What questions arise as you read this text?
- What does James mean in verse 20? How do you understand it?
- Compare James and Galatians. What do you see?
- In one sentence, summarize the main truth James is sharing.

Notes

Examen

This spiritual practice is attributed to Ignatius of Loyola (October 23, 1491–July 31, 1556). The purpose is to invite the Holy Spirit to help you become more self-aware as you seek the kingdom of God and His righteousness. Take a few minutes for each of the following points of reflection and prayer.

1. Place yourself in God's presence. Give thanks to God the Father for His great love for you, expressed by sending Jesus, God the Son. Take deep, slow breaths, inviting God the Holy Spirit to fill you as you put your faith in Jesus.
2. Pray for the grace to understand how God is working in your life. Soften your heart and invite Him to show you how He desires to empower, correct and mature you as you seek Him.
3. Reflect on your day with the following questions: What interactions did you have? What moments did you have by yourself? What feelings did you experience?
4. Examine what you did, said, or thought in those instances. What opportunities to reflect God's goodness did you take? How did you miss the mark?
5. Think through the day ahead. What interactions are you planning to have? What moments will you have by yourself? Resolve to be with God and reflect His goodness in each situation. Once again, take deep breaths as you invite the Holy Spirit to fill you. Thank Him for the blessing you received today. Receive His forgiveness for missing the mark. And ask Him to give you the virtue and wisdom you need for the coming day.

Resistance Scale

After each week's sermon, plot yourself on the following scale for the respective week.

Resisting God | **Resisting the devil**

Doubting God's goodness in my trials and believing He is holding out on me.

Trust

Trusting God is good, even in hardship, and rejecting the lie that He can't be trusted.

Knowing what God says but choosing not to act on it.

Obedience

Putting God's Word into action and refusing to stay passive.

Following my own desires and speaking in ways that create harm instead of peace.

Wisdom

Pursuing God's wisdom and choosing words and actions that bring peace and righteousness.

Wanting to rule my own life and resisting God's right to lead me.

Authority

Submitting to God's authority and rejecting pride and self-rule.

Trying to control outcomes, secure my future, and rely on myself instead of God.

Control

Trusting God with my plans, future, and results, and letting go of self-reliance.

Ignoring sin, avoiding change, and continuing down a path away from God.

Repentance

Turning back to God, confessing sin, and choosing the path that leads to life.

Additional Notes

Additional Notes

FLATLAND NEWS

4/12 **Spiritual Conversations** Sundays @6PM

4/14 **Emotionally Healthy Spirituality** Tuesdays @6AM

4/25 **Kid's Games & Donuts** Saturday @9AM

5/6 **Alpha Course** Wednesdays @7PM

5/10 **Mother's Day**

5/17 **Encounter/Family Dinner** Sunday @5:15PM

5/24 **Series 4 - Unmuted starts** - United Service @ 11AM

5/27 **How to Read the Psalms** Wednesdays @7PM

5/31 **Move Up Sunday & Kid's Summer Palooza**

6/1-5 **Youth Camp**

6/17-20 **Kids Camp**

Sign up or get more information for any of the above events or classes by using the QR code or visiting the information booth today!

FLATLAND CHURCH
4801 NORTH 144TH STREET OMAHA, NE 68116
402-492-9111
FLATLANDCHURCH.COM